

TWO GROUPS HELD FRONTS FOR REDS

Defunct Civil Rights Group and Peace Crusade Are Cited by U.S. Board

Special to The New York Times.

WASHINGTON, July 29—The Subversive Activities Control Board ruled today that the Civil Rights Congress and the American Peace Crusade were fronts for the Communist party.

They were directed to register with the Attorney General. This means that they must list their officers and give a financial accounting annually, unless the board is reversed on appeal to the courts. The decisions of the five-man board were unanimous.

The Supreme Court has not ruled on the constitutionality of the 1950 Subversive Activities Control Act, under which the board operates.

The board is bipartisan and has five members.

On application by the Attorney General or by any organization, it rules whether the organization is a "Communist-action organization," a "Communist-front organization," or a "Communist-infiltrated organization."

The board can determine whether an individual is a member of any Communist-action organization or an officer of a Communist-front organization registered, or required to be registered under the act.

Appeal Is Pending

A board ruling that found the Communist party a "Communist action" group is pending before the United States Court of Appeals.

The board said the two groups were under "direct control" of the Communist party.

The board said the Civil Rights Congress had been created by the Communist party to "utilize defense of civil rights" for party purposes and to raise and maintain defense and bail funds for party members.

The Congress was established in April, 1949, the board said, as a successor to the International Labor Defense as the party's legal arm. William L. Patterson was named executive secretary.

In January, 1956, Mr. Patterson filed an affidavit with the board declaring that the organization had been dissolved. The board said, however, that "the purported dissolution of the Civil Rights Congress is not such that the probability of continued activity in this field is to be discounted."

On the American Peace Crusade, the board said, the group was made up of a group of individuals banded "under the guise of promoting peace" to win supporters for the programs and policies of the Communist party and the world Communist movement.

Both Out of Business

Both the Civil Rights Congress and the American Peace Crusade have ceased operations. The Peace Crusade announced in 1955 that it was dissolving and the congress made a similar announcement last year.

Both said their decisions had been the result of "harassment" by the Government. The peace group had its headquarters at 35 West Twenty-sixth Street and the congress at 6 East Seventeenth Street.